

Course Recommendation Assistant

Hiring Assignment

Background

GradGuide conducts counselling sessions with students planning to study abroad. Counsellors consider a student's academic background, career goals, budget, preferred country, intake and other factors when recommending courses.

A key challenge is consistency: two students with very similar profiles may receive different course recommendations depending on which counsellor they speak to. We want to explore a tool that helps counsellors make more structured and consistent recommendations without replacing their judgment.

The Assignment

Build a Course Recommendation Assistant that a counsellor can use during a live counselling session. The assistant should take the student's profile and the counsellor's questions or input and surface relevant courses, universities and useful course information.

- Recommend relevant courses based on the student's profile.
- Show useful information such as university, country, fees, intake and eligibility.
- Explain why a course may be relevant to the student.
- Allow the counsellor to explore alternative recommendations.
- Allow the counsellor to search or ask questions about courses.

Live Counselling Experience

The counsellor may already be conducting the session on Google Meet. The assistant should work alongside the meeting without disrupting the conversation.

You decide the best interaction model. This could be a browser extension, floating panel, collapsible side panel, sticky-note style interface, or another approach you believe works better.

Your Product Decisions

Decide how the student profile is captured, how courses are matched and ranked, how recommendations are explained, and how the assistant handles incomplete information.

You may use a dataset, database, structured knowledge base or another approach of your choice to power the recommendations. Explain how your course data is structured and how it can be updated.

3 Original Features

Build three original features of your choice. We are intentionally not providing a list of suggested features because we want to see what problems you identify and how you choose to solve them.

For each feature, briefly explain the problem it solves, why it matters, and how it works.

Deliverables

- Working application – hosted link or clear run instructions.
- Source code – GitHub repository.
- Short write-up – explain your recommendation approach, interface and three feature decisions.
- Short video walkthrough – add it to the GitHub README.

What We Will Evaluate

- Quality and relevance of recommendations.
- Understanding of the counselling problem.
- Live meeting experience and usability.
- Consistency and explainability of recommendations.
- Quality of the three original features.
- Code quality and ability to explain design decisions.